



Hard Drive Space Issues

Q I have a Dell Inspiron 6400 with Vista Ultimate SP1 loaded on it. It runs an Intel Centrino Duo (1.73 GHz) with 1 GB of memory and a 120 GB HDD.

I have a few queries. Like I mentioned, I have a 120 GB hard drive. I'm able to use only 110 GB of the 120 GB. When I bought the laptop, it had Vista Home Premium and the local drive (C:) was a 110 GB and there was a backup drive of 10 GB. However even after formatting it completely and deleting the backup drive, I still don't get the complete 120 GB of space. I re-partitioned the drive as C (49.9 GB), D (29.9 GB) and E (31.7 GB). It adds up to 111.5 GB.

Is there anyway of using the remaining drive space as even the backup feature has stopped functioning now?

I used to run Disk Cleanup every week. It used to free up a maximum of 500 KB of space. Three months back, I installed Uniblue SpeedUpMyPC and Registry Booster. I stopped using Disk Cleanup. Now two days back when I started Disk Cleanup and scanned my 29.9 GB partition, it says that 159 GB can be freed when my entire drive itself is only 120 GB!

My friend too had the same issue after installing some software. And he did disk cleanup. All of his software got uninstalled and Vista crashed. I don't know what to do now.

I am sure that there are no viruses on my laptop as I download and install software only from trusted sites and I use the latest version of Kaspersky 2009. I keep it updated.

Anand Ravindran

A The problem with the drive space is because of the conversion of bytes to kilobytes and megabytes and so on. A kilobyte is actually a 1024 bytes not a 1000. All this adds up to a big number when you calculate capacities such as 120 GB. For example, an advertised 750

GB drive is actually close to 698 GB. The same is the case with your 120 GB drive.

If your Disk Cleanup is showing strange hard drive space values, try running a `chkdsk` on all the partitions. To do this, click on `Start > Run`. Type `chkdsk C: /f` and click OK. You might be needed to restart. Do the same step for all the partitions and the incorrect space issue might get solved.

Laptop Not Performing Well

Q I had purchased an Acer Aspire 4520 laptop. It came with an AMD Athlon 64 X2, an NVIDIA 7000m graphics solution. I upgraded its memory from 1 GB to 4 GB. I am using Windows Vista Ultimate 32-bit. The problem I have is that it is running slowly. Games still do not run smoothly, so is there any way to increase the performance?

Sachin Wadnere

A While the processor and the amount of RAM is sufficient for most applications, modern games required a solid graphics solution to run perfectly. The NVIDIA 7000m is not the best in its class and its no surprise it struggles to run today's games. Unfortunately, there isn't a lot you can do to change this.

Display Problems

Q Here are my system specifications: Intel Pentium 4 1.7 GHz Willamette processor, Gigabyte GA-8SMML Motherboard, 512 MB PC133 MHz SDRAM, 160W SMPS, SiS 650 Chipset onboard video, SiS 7012 Onboard audio, PS2 Keyboard and mouse, HCL HCM580M 15-inch CRT Monitor, Samsung CD-ROM and Pioneer DVD -RW DL

I recently bought one more 512 MB 133 MHz SDRAM. When I powered on the computer after adding the RAM, the monitor remained blank and there was no beep from the motherboard. I had to restart it several times and then the computer booted. I tried using the two RAM sticks separately and they worked fine. However they do not seem to be working properly together. When I used them together again the monitor remained in its standby mode (Orange LED) even though the computer was ON. When I restarted the computer I received a message – "SiS 650 32 MB Video" and there was a one continuous long beep and it just hung there. The computer boots once in 5 or 6 times and the remaining times the monitor is blank or I receive the above message. I even tried using a Zebronic 450 Watt SMPS, but it didn't help. Please help. I am getting desperate day by day. Also my monitor displays everything in blue and after around an hour it comes back to normal color. When the monitor is shaken, it changes colour from blue to normal and then goes back to blue.

Also my friend wants to buy an XFX 7600GT AGP card. Will it work in a 4X slot? And how much would it cost? Please help.

Shreyas Vaidya



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@thinkdigit.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!